



DEZERV

Product Teardown

How India's only digitally-native full-stack wealth manager
is rebuilding private banking from scratch

Brijesh Harish Bolar · May 2026

●
ACT 1

The Opportunity

India's wealth creation moment — and the supply-side crisis that defines it

01

India's Wealth Creation Moment

4th

Largest economy globally
(GDP \$4 trillion+)

10M+

Families with investable
assets above ₹1 crore

\$1T

Projected wealth management
AUM by 2040 (EY)



India is in the middle of a generational wealth creation event — and the financial services industry has not kept pace.

1,000

WEALTHY FAMILIES PER RELATIONSHIP MANAGER

India has ~11,000 registered RMs serving 10 million wealthy households.
Indians are creating wealth faster than the wealth management industry can serve them.

Mis-selling at Scale

RMs earn commissions on product placement, not client outcomes. Portfolios built for distributor incentives, not client goals.

The Accidental Portfolio

HNIs accumulate instruments over time — NFO MFs, ULIPs, FDs — with no plan, no structure, no active management.

The New-Wealth Gap

ESOP recipients, startup founders, young CXOs — too complex for DIY, not served by traditional private banking.

Why Now — Three Forces Converged in 2021



Digital Infrastructure Maturity

- UPI, Account Aggregator, SEBI e-KYC rails
- CAS integration for full portfolio linking
- Plumbing for fully digital wealth management — absent 5 years prior



Trust Inflection Point

- Post-Covid portfolio review moment
- MF mis-selling, ULIP era, Franklin Templeton debt crisis
- Investors actively seeking a conflict-free alternative



Founder Timing

- Three co-founders left legacy firms simultaneously
- ₹50,000 Cr managed across prior careers
- Shared diagnosis of what was broken — and how to fix it

- **ACT 2**

The Company

Founding story, team, scale, and the capital that built it

02

Company Snapshot

₹17,000 Cr

Total AUM
(March 2026)

6,568

PMS Clients
across 900+ pin codes

200+

Cities Served
digitally

500+

Professionals
110+ in tech/product

₹850 Cr

Total Funding
4 rounds

2021

Founded
April, Mumbai

The Founding Moment

During Covid, Sandeep Jethwani looked at the portfolio of a senior Big 4 partner — smart, successful, financially aware. What he found was severe over-diversification, high hidden costs, and no active management. A person who had built a significant career had been taken for a ride by the very industry meant to serve him.



***If smart, successful people are being taken for a ride,
the new wealth creator has no chance.***

— Sandeep Jethwani, Co-founder, Dezerv

Dezerv was incorporated in April 2021.

The Founding Team



Sandeep Jethwani

Co-founder · IIFL Wealth

Computer Engineering, VJTI
Mumbai · MBA, IIM Bangalore ·
Public voice, weekly newsletter



Vaibhav Porwal

Co-founder · Anand Rathi Wealth

Investment strategy & market
positioning · Asset allocation
philosophy lead



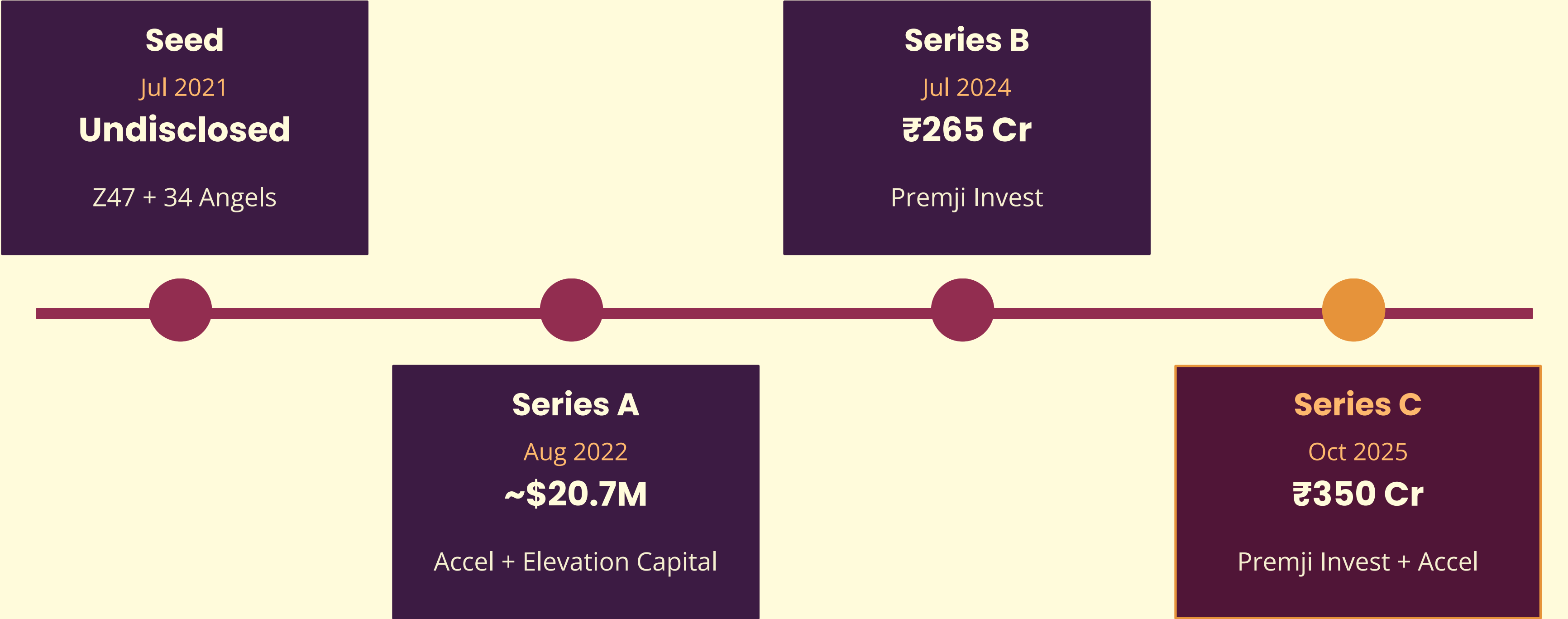
Sahil Contractor

Co-founder · Kotak Wealth Management

Business & new initiatives ·
Product structure, full-family-
wealth expansion

₹50,000 Cr managed across prior careers · Veterans of IIFL Wealth, Kotak Wealth & Anand Rathi Wealth

Funding Trajectory — ₹850 Cr Raised Across 4 Rounds



Series C Signal: All-primary · No secondary exits · All existing investors re-upped · Premji Invest cited 'AI-enabled prospecting' and 'robust unit economics'

- **ACT 3**

The Problem

The trust gap — why the incumbent model fails
India's new wealth creators

03

Dezerv is not solving a product gap. It is solving a trust gap.

The incumbent model is structurally misaligned with client interests

Mis-selling at Scale

RMs earn commissions on product placement, not outcomes. The incentive is transaction volume and product mix — not client returns. Clients bear the cost invisibly.

The Accidental Portfolio

Portfolios collected over time — MFs bought in NFO season, ULIPs sold by branch RMs, FDs opened opportunistically. No plan connects them. No one manages the whole.

The New-Wealth Access Gap

ESOP recipients, founders, and young CXOs sit in no-man's-land. Too complex for DIY. Not served by traditional private banking designed for old money.

The Geography Problem

Quality wealth management has historically been a Tier-1 privilege. A client in Indore gets local advisors with limited product access and no institutional rigour.

What a Mis-Sold Portfolio Looks Like

TYPICAL HNI PORTFOLIO

- 30+ mutual funds (massive overlap)
- Regular plans — paying hidden trail
- Insurance-linked products as 'investments'
- No coherent asset allocation logic
- Portfolio never actively managed
- Client unaware of actual costs borne

**Hidden commission drag:
₹1–2L/yr on a ₹1 Cr portfolio**



WHAT IT SHOULD LOOK LIKE

- 6–8 funds with zero overlap
- Direct plans — zero trail commission
- Investments and insurance separated
- Disciplined multi-asset allocation
- Actively managed, reviewed quarterly
- Full cost transparency in-app

**Dezerv's Equity Revival Strategy:
direct plans only — zero trail**

- **ACT 4**

The Product

Dual-app architecture, the conversion funnel, and the full strategy stack

04

Most platforms show you what to buy.

**Dezerv shows you what's wrong
with what you already have.**

The sequencing — diagnosis before prescription — is the entire acquisition strategy.

By the time the RM makes contact, the client already trusts the data.

Every Product Decision Traces Back to the Diagnosis

1

Wealth Monitor

Exists to make mis-selling visible before the commercial conversation starts. The audit is the trust-building mechanism.

2

Direct-to-Client Model

Removes the distributor conflict entirely. No broker, no intermediary between Dezerv and the investor's outcome.

3

Discretionary Mandate

Dezerv owns portfolio outcomes rather than just recommending thus making it accountable for performance.

4

Technology Layer

Delivers institutional rigour to clients who previously had no access to it.

5

Transparent Fee Model

Realigns incentives between firm and client. Fixed 1% or performance 10% with high-watermark — earn only when clients earn.

The Dual-App Architecture — Two Apps, One Funnel

WEALTH MONITOR • FREE

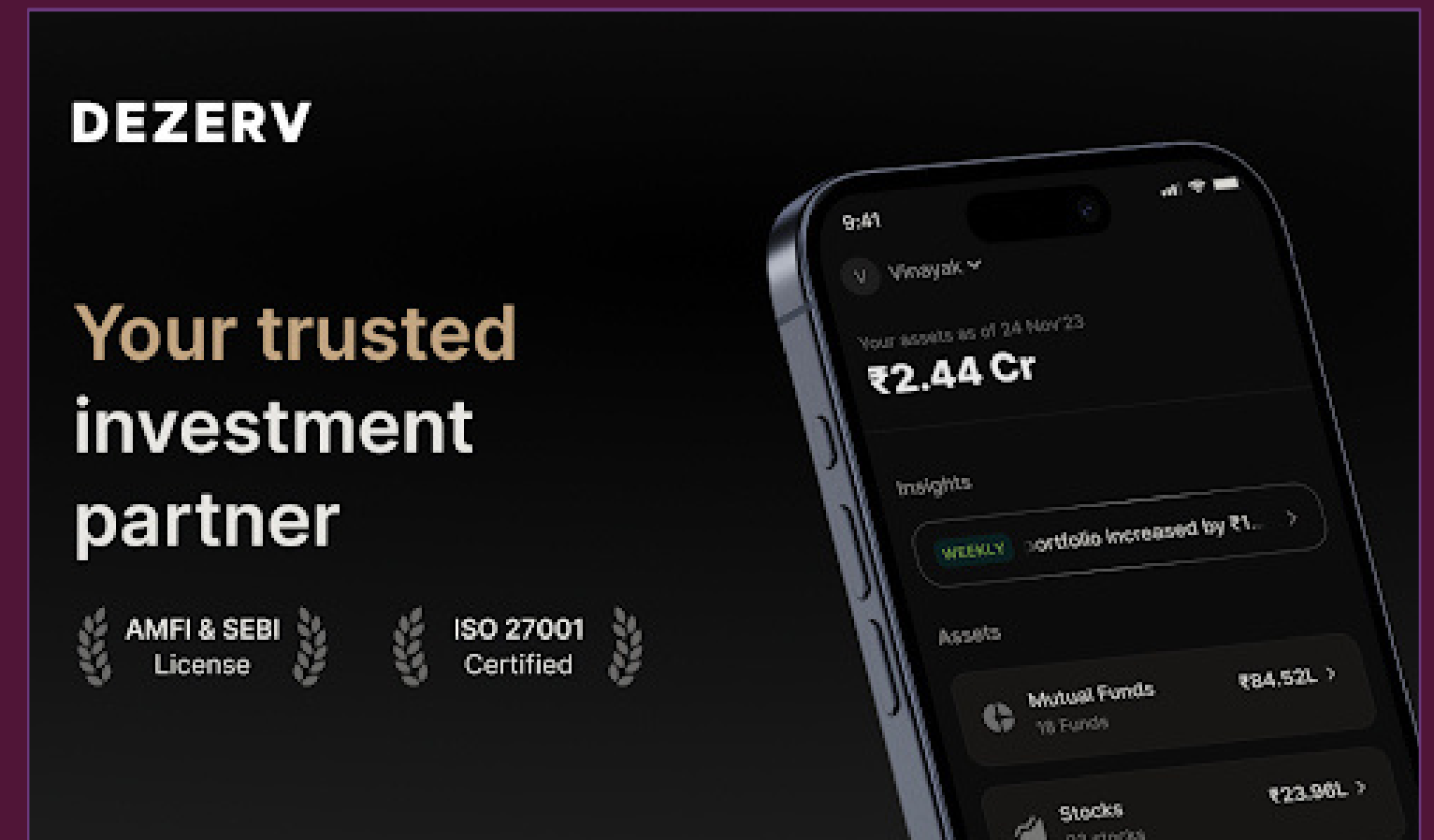


- 700K+ users · ₹2.5L Cr tracked
- Portfolio health score & audit
- Underperformance + hidden cost alerts
- CAS / broker linking — no Dezerv account needed



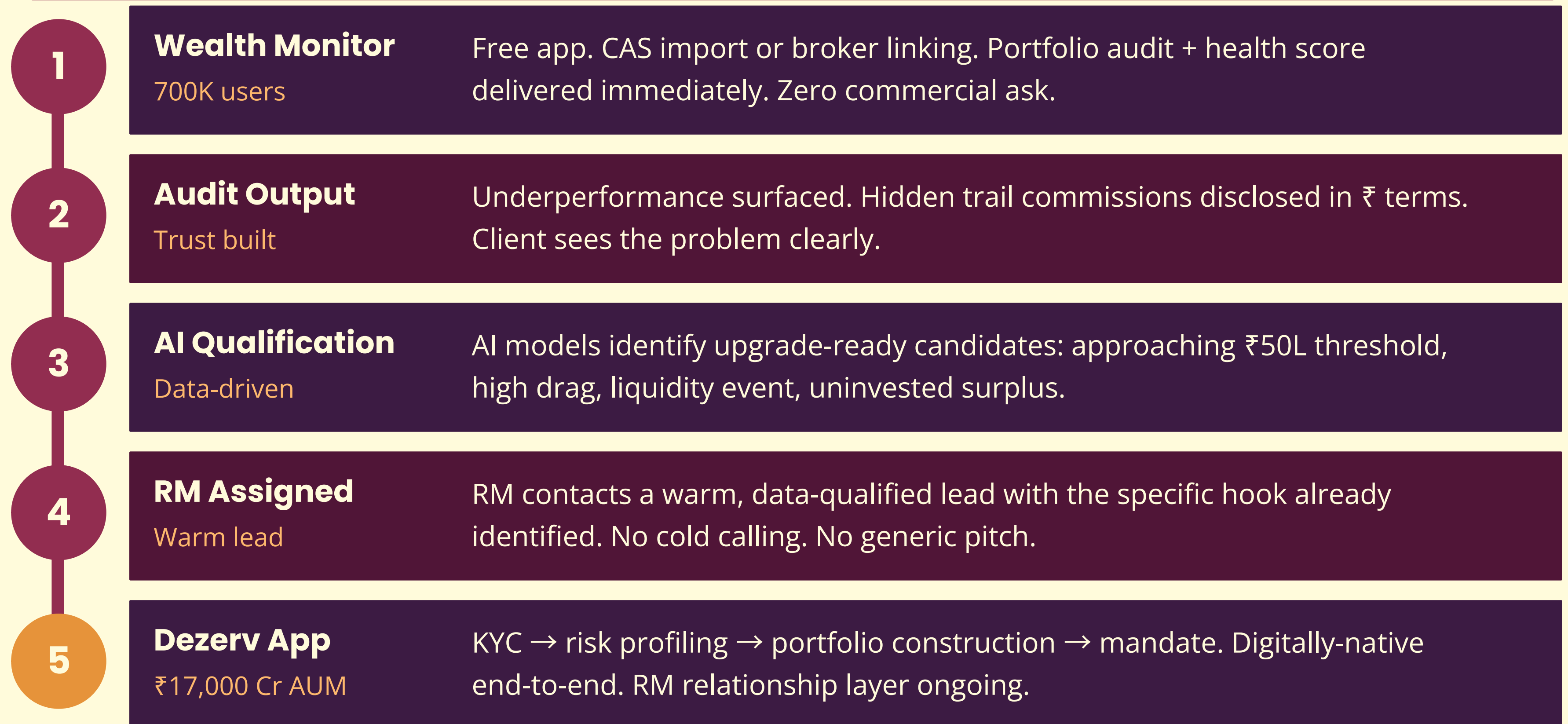
AI
qualify

DEZERV APP • KYC-GATED



- 6,568 PMS clients · ₹17,000 Cr AUM
- PMS, AIF subscriptions, IPA MF
- RM-assigned post qualification
- Full portfolio management + reporting

How the Funnel Works — The RM is Closing, Not Pitching



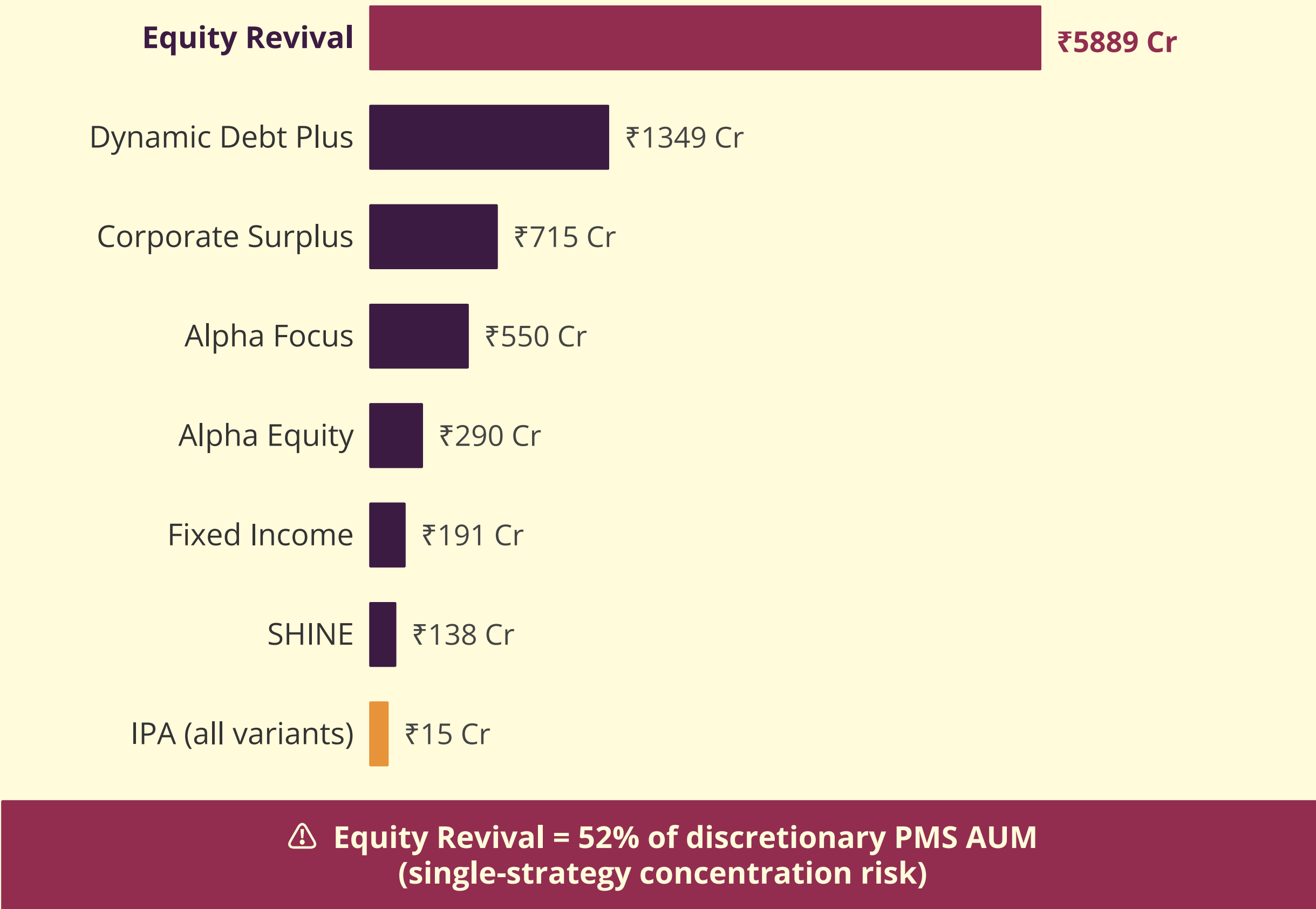
Data moat: AI models trained on 700K portfolios identify which users are ready to upgrade — and exactly why — before the RM picks up the phone.

The Full Product Stack — Entry to Institutional

Min. Ticket	Product	Type	Fee Model
₹50,000	IPA (Integrated Portfolio Approach) <i>Entry product. Multi-asset MF portfolio. Earned via ARN 248439.</i>	MF Distribution	Trail commission (disclosed in-app)
₹50 Lakhs	PMS — Portfolio Management Service <i>Core revenue driver. Equity Revival Strategy: direct plans, zero trail.</i>	Discretionary / Active	Fixed 1% or Performance 10% (high-watermark)
₹1 Crore	Cat I AIF — Innovation Fund <i>Startup deal-based investments. Rare for a wealth manager to hold Cat I.</i>	Angel / VCF Structure	Mgmt fee + carry
₹1 Crore	Cat II AIF — Alternatives Trust <i>Private credit and structured products for alternatives allocation.</i>	Private Credit / Structured	Mgmt fee + carry
₹1 Crore	Cat III AIF — Alpha Equity Trust <i>All three AIF categories held simultaneously — rare in Indian wealthtech.</i>	Long-short / Absolute Return	Mgmt fee + carry

SHINE (precious metals PMS) · Direct bonds · REITs · InvITs · Loans · Credit cards — planned FY26 additions

Strategy Concentration + Entity Architecture



Dezerv Investments Pvt Ltd

SEBI Portfolio Manager
(INP000007377)

Investment Manager:
Cat I, II, III AIFs
All PMS strategies + AIF vehicles

Dezerv Distribution Services Pvt Ltd

AMFI MF Distributor (ARN 248439)
IPA MF portfolios only
Earns trail commission — disclosed in-app

Conflict-of-interest wall built into the corporate architecture

- **ACT 5**

Business Model

How Dezerv makes money — fee structure,
unit economics, path to profitability

05

How Dezerv Makes Money

PMS Management Fee

Primary revenue driver

- Fixed fee: up to 1% of invested assets p.a.
- OR Performance fee: up to 10% of returns
- High-watermark: earn only on new highs — not drawdown recovery
- Equity Revival (₹5,889 Cr): direct MF plans, zero trail

AIF Fee + Carry

Growing with AIF book

- Annual management fee: typically 1–2%
- Performance carry: 10–20% above hurdle rate
- Three separate vehicles: Cat I, II, III
- Richer economics than PMS as AIF book scales

Trail Commission (IPA)

Funnel monetisation

- Earned via Dezerv Distribution Services (ARN 248439)
- Trail rate: ~0.5–1% on regular plan MF assets
- Disclosed in-app — transparency design choice
- IPA is funnel product; real AUM is in PMS/AIF

When your revenue is tied to client outcomes rather than transaction volumes, your incentives naturally align with theirs.

Unit Economics — FY25 Actuals

Revenue from operations	₹66 Cr
Fees & commission income	₹44 Cr (4x YoY)
Net loss	₹112 Cr
Employee costs	₹111 Cr (76% YoY ↑)
Software expenses	₹8 Cr (220% YoY ↑)
Marketing	₹30 Cr (67% YoY ↑)
Unit cost per ₹1 revenue	₹2.70
Implied take rate on AUM	~0.47%
Cash & bank balance	₹204 Cr (Mar '25)

Reading the Numbers

Front-loaded investment, not mismanagement

People (₹111 Cr), tech (220% YoY), brand (₹30 Cr) — all three levers pulled simultaneously. This is expected stage-appropriate burn.

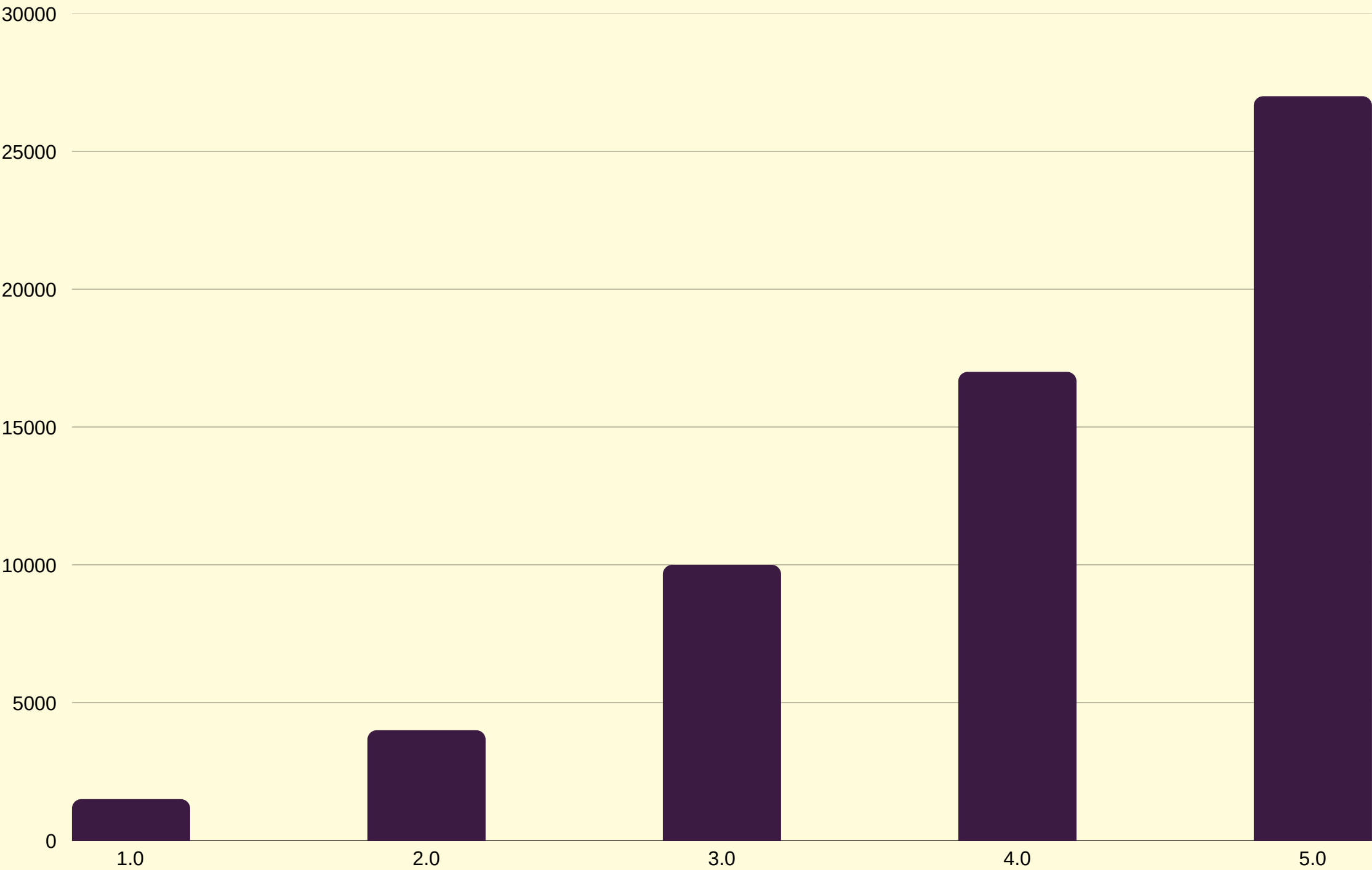
Take rate gap is structural, not permanent

0.47% vs 1%+ target. Gap closes as AIF book scales — management fee + carry economics are richer than PMS fees alone.

Runway is comfortable

₹204 Cr cash + ₹350 Cr Series C = 18–24 months at current burn. Revenue 2.5x'd in FY25 — trajectory is closing the gap.

Path to Profitability — The AUM Compounding Story



The cost base is largely fixed. Revenue is a % of AUM. As AUM doubles, operating leverage kicks in — the same 110-person tech team serves ₹30,000 Cr as well as ₹17,000 Cr.

₹25,000–30,000 Cr

AUM Target FY27

Roughly double from March 2026

0.6–0.7%

Take Rate Target

Up from 0.47% as AIF book scales

₹150–175 Cr

Revenue at Breakeven

Current cost base approaches breakeven

- **ACT 6**

Performance

Does the product actually deliver? SEBI-verified data, not marketing material.

06

Equity Performance vs Benchmark — SEBI Filed, March 2026

Strategy	AUM (₹ Cr)	1Y Return	BSE500TRI 1Y	Alpha	Since Inception	Benchmark SI
Equity Revival (flagship)	5,889	-2.32%	-3.12%	+0.80%	14.23%	12.69%
Alpha Focus	550	+0.56%	-3.12%	+3.68%	16.95%	10.94%
Alpha Equity	290	-0.97%	-3.12%	+2.15%	13.14%	11.89%
Alpha Beta Equity	30	-2.09%	-3.12%	+1.03%	12.14%	9.75%
Capital Reserve-Equity	284	-1.32%	-3.12%	+1.80%	-1.83%	-8.91%

Every equity strategy beat the benchmark over 1 year and since inception. SEBI-filed data, not marketing material. Alpha Focus: +600 bps over benchmark since inception. Down-capture philosophy visible in falling market.

Debt Alpha, SHINE Performance + Concentration Risk

Strategy	AUM	1Y Return	Benchmark	Alpha
Dynamic Debt Plus	₹1,349 Cr	12.2%	3.82%	+8.38%
Dynamic Debt	₹252 Cr	10.58%	3.82%	+6.76%
Corporate Surplus	₹715 Cr	7.49%	3.82%	+3.67%
Fixed Income	₹191 Cr	7.05%	3.82%	+3.23%

Benchmark: CRISIL Composite Bond Index

Dynamic Debt Plus: 12.2% vs 3.82% benchmark. Not just a performance story — a product expansion story. Clients proactively asking for fixed income in first conversations.

Concentration Risk: 52% of discretionary PMS AUM in Equity Revival alone. If this strategy underperforms for two consecutive years, the majority of clients are simultaneously affected.

SHINE — Natural Elements Strategy

60.6%

since inception

vs benchmark: 5.13% · AUM: ₹138 Cr

- **ACT 7**

GTM & Competitive

The product IS the GTM — and why incumbents cannot replicate the model

07

Go-to-Market: The Product IS the GTM

1

Organic Acquisition *via Wealth Monitor*

700K users enter voluntarily. Free audit delivers value before any commercial ask. Frictionless, geographically-unconstrained, trust-first.

2

AI-Driven Qualification *data moat in action*

Models trained on 700K portfolios identify upgrade-ready candidates by signal: AUM threshold, commission drag, liquidity event, surplus. RM gets a warm, context-rich lead.

3

RM Conversion + Onboarding *closing, not pitching*

RM contacts with the specific hook. Dezerv App handles KYC → risk profiling → mandate. Post-onboarding: clients add 40–50% more capital in year 2 and refer peers.

5 Offices

Mumbai · Delhi · Bengaluru
Hyderabad · Pune

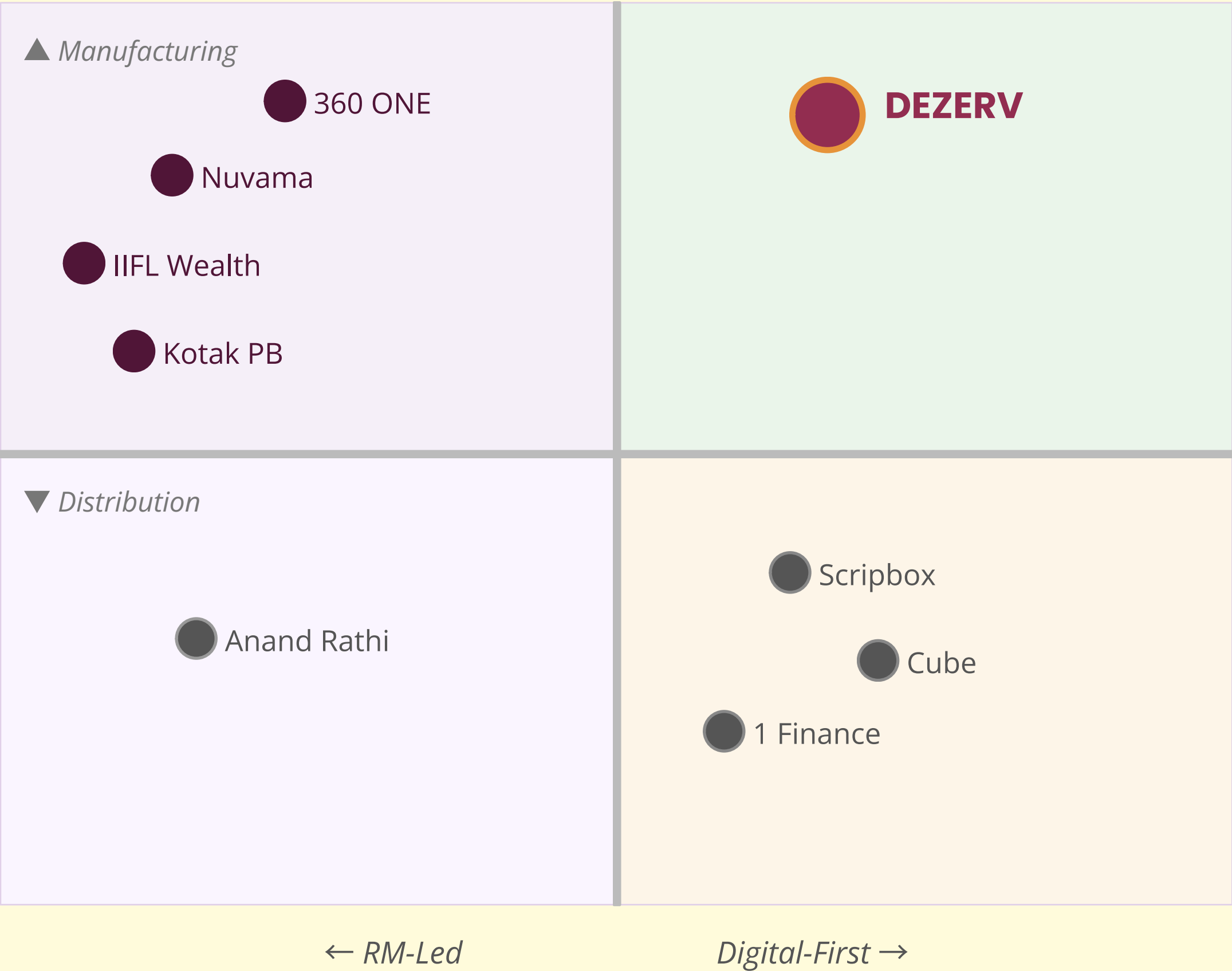
900+

Pin codes served digitally —
Tier-2 reach without Tier-2 offices

₹30 Cr

Marketing spend on ₹66 Cr revenue —
brand investment, not performance CAC

Competitive Landscape — The Unoccupied Quadrant



The Unoccupied Quadrant

Dezerv occupies a position that no other player in Indian wealthtech currently holds:

- **Institutional-quality**
- **Conflict-free**
- **Discretionary mandate**
- **Digitally-native funnel**
- **Accessible to first-gen HNIs**

*Digital peers: funnel, not manufacturing.
Legacy firms: manufacturing, not digital model.
Dezerv has both.*

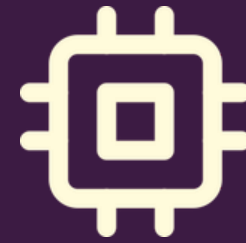
**The moat is not technology.
It is business model.**

Why Incumbents Cannot Replicate This



Cultural Barrier

The incumbent model is built on RM relationships and commission revenue. Building a tool that surfaces hidden charges would immediately undermine the RM's credibility and the firm's revenue. The incumbent cannot make the trust argument while earning trail from the products it recommends.



Technical Barrier

Legacy wealth firms run on CRM and reporting tools built for RM-led delivery. Consumer-grade portfolio audit apps with AI-driven qualification require a different engineering culture. Listed firms with quarterly earnings pressure cannot make this quality of investment without shareholder questions.



Incentive Misalignment

Listed firms face quarterly revenue pressure. Building a free app that converts users over 12–18 months is not a quarterly story. Dezerv, as a growth-stage private company, can make the 3–5 year investment without quarterly accountability — a structural advantage that disappears post-IPO.

- **ACT 8**

AI Strategy

Three layers, one thesis: AI solves the supply problem, not the trust problem

08

The AI Strategy — Three Layers, One Direction

NOW	Internal AI — Deployed	NEAR-TERM	AI Voice Agent	2026+	Agentic Systems
Build the Foundation Inside First		RM-Equivalent Top-of-Funnel		Observe → Plan → Act	
• Institutional memory capture — client context never lost when RM changes • RM training — simulate client conversations, compress time to client-ready • Prospecting qualification — AI models on 700K portfolios identify upgrade signals • Operational automation — rebalancing, reporting, compliance, meeting prep		• AI voice agent trained on Dezerv knowledge base — demoed internally Mar 2025 • Indistinguishable from human: speed, accent, accuracy, contextual understanding • Handles first 2-3 qualification conversations before RM engagement • Built by non-technical team member in 4 hours — signals ease of iteration		• Agents continuously monitor 700K+ portfolios for signals: drift, events, gaps • LLM reasoning prioritises which clients need attention and what action to take • Draft RM recommendations, prepare client comms — human approves at gate • Target: 80%+ of customer interactions handled autonomously by 2030	

AI Solves the Supply Problem. Not the Trust Problem.

The Supply Problem

10,000,000

wealthy households

11,000

registered relationship managers

= 1,000 wealthy families per RM

The AI Solution

Bring all non-client-facing RM activity to zero

AI handles: prospecting, qualification, meeting prep, rebalancing, reporting, compliance

RM handles: relationship, counsel, complex need, the trust moment

Same RM headcount serves dramatically more clients at identical quality

- **ACT 9**

The Verdict

What's working, what to watch, insights and the final verdict through PM Lens

09

What's Working

11x AUM in 39 Months

₹1,500 Cr (Dec '22) → ₹17,000 Cr (Mar '26). AUM growth is the aggregated output of acquisition, retention, and performance — all three working simultaneously.

Every Equity Strategy Beats Benchmark

SEBI-filed data, not marketing material. Alpha Focus: +600 bps over BSE500TRI since inception. Down-capture philosophy visible in a falling market.

700K Portfolio Data Moat

₹2.5 lakh crore tracked. No traditional firm has this signal quality. No digital peer has the product to monetise it. Unique in Indian wealthtech.

Clients Add 40–50% Capital in Year 2

Then refer peers. Evidence the product experience works — not just satisfaction, but expansion and advocacy. Reduces CAC, increases LTV.

Debt Alpha: 12.2% vs 3.82% Benchmark

Not just a performance story — a product expansion story. Clients proactively asking for fixed income in first conversations, and the product delivers.

Zero SEBI Complaints — 6,568 Clients

SEBI-filed, not self-reported. Managing ₹11,342 Cr across 6,568 PMS clients. Strongest publicly available proxy for client satisfaction.

What to Watch

Equity Revival Concentration

52% of PMS AUM in one strategy. Two years of underperformance affects the majority of clients simultaneously. Concentrated reputation risk.

Take Rate Gap

0.47% implied vs 1%+ target. Gap closes as AIF book scales — management fee + carry are richer. Monitor AIF share of total AUM as leading indicator.

IPA Monetisation Gap

IPA earns trail at 0.5–1%, not PMS fees. The IPA → PMS transition mechanics are the unit economics lever nobody is talking about publicly.

Credit Expansion Conflict Risk

Loans against investments create incentives to keep clients invested even when liquidation is right. The trust proposition gets harder to defend as product range widens.

Burn and Runway

₹2.70 to earn ₹1. Series C + cash gives 18–24 months. Profitability requires AUM to roughly double while holding the cost base relatively flat.

RM Quality at Scale

80 trainees in one quarter. Culture of advice over sales is fragile at rapid scale. Quality dilution is the execution risk that doesn't show up in quarterly metrics.

The Three Sharpest Insights

01

Diagnosis–Before–Prescription Funnel = Structural Moat

Wealth Monitor is only possible for a firm with nothing to hide about its own revenue model. No incumbent can build this without surfacing their own conflicts to their own clients. The moat is business model, not technology — and business model gaps require firms to cannibalise themselves to close.

02

'RM Non–Client–Facing Activity to Zero' = Most Precise AI KPI in Indian Fintech

Most AI claims in wealthtech are unmeasurable. This one is not. It has a clear before state, a clear after state, and a clear mechanism. It reveals how Dezerv thinks about AI — not as a client feature, but as an operating model transformation. The client benefit is indirect. The business benefit is direct.

03

Entity Architecture = Product Strategy Made Operational

The two-entity structure is not regulatory housekeeping. It is the structural proof of the conflict-of-interest argument. Running Equity Revival (₹5,889 Cr) on direct MF plans makes the transparency claim verifiable, not just positioned.

The Engineering Lens

What building inside a private bank teaches you about what Dezerv is replacing

Legacy Systems: Premium Experience Despite the Infrastructure

Institutional private banks deliver a genuine premium experience — but it sits on top of fragmented systems, batch-process portfolio reporting, and manual RM workflows. The experience is delivered by skilled people working around system limitations, not because of the systems.

Dezerv's Advantage: No Technical Debt, Built for Real-Time

Every system designed from scratch — single integrated data layer, real-time portfolio engine, AI models trained on live signals. The 110+ member engineering team for a ₹17,000 Cr AUM firm is not oversized. It is the investment required to build in 4 years what a legacy bank accumulated over 4 decades — without the debt.

The Compounding Gap: Modern Infrastructure Improves Faster

Every year Dezerv's engineering team ships, the legacy firm's relative position worsens. Retrofitting modern capabilities onto fragmented systems is slower than building new capabilities on modern infrastructure. Technical debt is a gravitational force. Dezerv has none.

THE OPEN STRATEGIC QUESTION

Can Dezerv expand into credit, loans, and family office services without diluting the conflict-free trust proposition that drove 11x AUM growth?

- **Every product added beyond core investment management adds a potential conflict.**

A loan against PMS creates an incentive to keep clients invested even when liquidation is in their interest. A credit card in the same app as the wealth portfolio creates upsell pressure that could compromise advisory objectivity.

- **The 'financial institution' ambition is the right long-term vision.**

Global private banks operate exactly this way — investment + credit + succession under one relationship. But they also took decades to develop the conflict management frameworks required. Dezerv is attempting this in years.

- **How Dezerv navigates the conflict architecture defines the next chapter.**

The trust proposition that built the first ₹17,000 Cr is fragile in the face of product expansion. Maintaining it as they scale into credit is the defining strategic test — and the question that will determine whether Dezerv becomes India's next great financial institution.

Final Verdict

Dezerv has built the most thoughtfully architected wealth management platform in India today — not just as a product, but as a system. The dual-app funnel, the conflict-free entity structure, the AI-first operating model, and the engineering-first infrastructure combine into something that is genuinely difficult to replicate for reasons that go beyond technology.

01

Conflict-Free Model

Cannot be replicated without cannibalising existing revenue.
Business model gap,
not technology gap.

02

700K Portfolio Data Moat

4 years to build. Compounds with every new Wealth Monitor user.
No incumbent has equivalent signal quality.

03

Manufacturing + Distribution + Tech

PMS + Cat I/II/III AIF + digital funnel.
No other player in the HNI segment currently combines all three.

***“Dezerv is not trying to be a better version of 360 ONE.
It is trying to make the 360 ONE model obsolete.”***

Sources & Data Vintage

Series C Announcement (Oct 2025)

dezerv.in/blog — primary source for funding, investor quotes, product roadmap

Hubbis Interview (Mar 2026)

Sandeep Jethwani — AUM update (₹17,000 Cr), ICP detail, AI internal-first confirmation

FY25 Financials (Feb 2026)

Entrackr/BW Disrupt via RoC filings — revenue, cost structure, unit economics

BW Disrupt Interview (2025)

Jethwani on data-led approach, AUM trajectory, tech-first philosophy

Tracxn Company Profile

Cap table structure, investor list, competitor set

Moneycontrol Interview (Dec 2025)

Sandeep Jethwani — fee structure, competitive framing, AI strategy, segment data

SEBI PMS Monthly Report (Mar 2026)

INP000007377 — strategy-level AUM, performance (TWRR), client data, complaints

AI Agents Blog Post (Mar 2025)

dezerv.in/blog — Jethwani's AI architecture thesis, voice agent demo, agentic vision

SEBI Registrations

dezerv.in footer + SEBI PMS portal — entity structure, registration numbers

*Data vintage: SEBI PMS filing March 2026 · FY25 RoC financials
All performance data TWRR as filed with SEBI*